The 2027 Harbourgate patrol slate moves into the small hours

Bethan Murray, Community Safety Manager. For the council's community safety committee at the annual review, 29 January 2027.

Recommendation

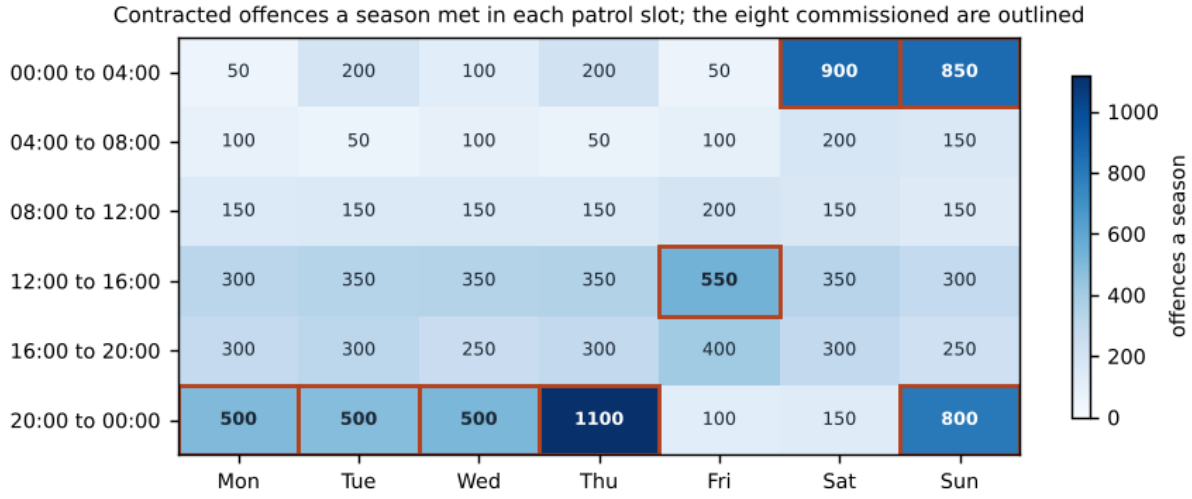
Commission the eight slots in the table below: the five weekday evenings and Sunday evening, the small hours of Saturday and Sunday where the late licences push the trouble past midnight, and Friday afternoon. The agreement covers 12,510 recorded offences a season in the quarter, and over a season those eight slots would have a patrol on the ground for 5,700 of them, against 3,150 for the eight slots the windows' midpoints put first. The ninth slot by weight is Friday 16:00 to 20:00, at 400 against the 500 of the weakest of the eight, so the eight are not finely balanced and the slate should hold for the whole season, as clause 6.1 requires.

The eight slots

Slot	Offences a season met in it
Thursday 20:00 to 00:00	1,100
Saturday 00:00 to 04:00	900
Sunday 00:00 to 04:00	850
Sunday 20:00 to 00:00	800
Friday 12:00 to 16:00	550
Wednesday 20:00 to 00:00	500
Monday 20:00 to 00:00	500
Tuesday 20:00 to 00:00	500
The eight together	5,700

Source: the records management extract of 22 January 2027, offences of the classes at Annex B recorded at the five locations in the quarter's location register, 1 April to 30 September 2025 and 2026. Figures are one season, the mean of the two on record, to the nearest fifty offences.

The week



How the figures are built

Most of these offences were not seen happening. A business is shut at ten and open at seven and the shutter has been forced; a car is left at the Quayside at half past eight and the window is out by one. The record holds the two times the victim can vouch for and nothing between them, and for four in five of the covered offences they are more than four hours apart, so no slot figure can be read off the record directly. What the record does settle is the quarter's own clock: the hours its offences fall in are the hours that make the windows the force actually recorded the likeliest set of windows to have been recorded, and that is a

single answer because the windows cut the week at a hundred and fifty-nine different hours. A slot's figure is that clock summed over the slot, over the two seasons on record, divided by two. The workbook harbourgate_slot_weights.xlsx carries the figure for every slot in the week, and the volume, location and footfall tables behind this paper.

The figures are not what a flat reading of the windows gives. Treating an offence as equally likely in every hour of its own window credits a slate of 3,150 offences a season and puts the patrol on the afternoons, because the windows that cover a Friday or a Saturday night are weekend closures three to four times longer than a Tuesday's, and a flat reading divides the weekend's offences across all of those hours. Those eight slots would in fact have a patrol present for 4,250, a quarter less than the slate above.